

- 17 As we collect the utmost debt, even the eighth and sixteenth part,
So unto *Āptya* we transfer together all the evil dream.
- 18 Now have we conquered and obtained, and from our trespasses are free.
Shine thou away the evil dream, O Dawn, whereof we are afraid. Yours are incomparable aids, and good the succour they afford.

HYMN XLVIII.

Soma.

- WISELY have I enjoyed the savoury viand, religious-thoughted,
best to find out treasure,
The food to which all Deities and mortals, calling it meath,
gather themselves together.
- 2 Thou shalt be *Aditi* as thou hast entered within, appeaser of celestial anger.
Indu, enjoying *Indra*'s friendship, bring us—as a swift steed the car—forward to riches.
- 3 We have drunk *Soma* and become immortal; we have attained the light, the Gods discovered.
Now what may foeman's malice do to harm us? What, O Immortal, mortal man's deception?
- 4 Absorbed into the heart, be sweet, O *Indu*, as a kind father to his son, O *Soma*,
As a wise Friend to friend: do thou, wide-ruler, O *Soma*,
lengthen out our days for living.
- 5 These glorious drops that give me freedom have I drunk.
Closely they knit my joints as straps secure a car.
Let them protect my foot from slipping on the way: yea, let the drops I drink preserve me from disease.
- 6 Make me shine bright like fire produced by friction: give us a clearer sight and make us better.
For in carouse I think of thee, O *Soma*, Shall I, as a rich man, attain to comfort?
- 7 May we enjoy with an enlivened spirit the juice thou givest,
like ancestral riches.
O *Soma*, King, prolong thou our existence as *Súrya* makes the shining days grow longer.

1 *Meath*: *mādhū*: or, sweet.

2 *Within*: within my heart. *Indu*: *Soma*.

3 *We have drunk Soma*: see Muir, *O. S. Texts*, III. 264, 265.

5 *From slipping on the way*: 'may they keep us from a loosely-knit worship.'—Wilson,

- 8 King Soma, favour us and make us prosper : we are thy devotees ; of this be mindful.
Spirit and power are fresh in us, O Indu : give us not up unto our foeman's pleasure.
- 9 For thou hast settled in each joint, O Soma, aim of men's eyes and guardian of our bodies.
When we offend against thine holy statutes, as a kind Friend, God, best of all, be gracious.
- 10 May I be with the Friend whose heart is tender, who, Lord of Bays ! when quaffed will never harm me —
This Soma now deposited within me. For this, I pray for longer life to Indra.
- 11 Our maladies have lost their strength and vanished : they feared, and passed away into the darkness.
Soma hath risen in us, exceeding mighty, and we are come where men prolong existence.
- 12 Fathers, that Indu which our hearts have drunken, Immortal in himself, hath entered mortals.
So let us serve this Soma with oblation, and rest securely in his grace and favour.
- 13 Associate with the Fathers thou, O Soma, hast spread thyself abroad through earth and heaven.
So with oblation let us serve thee, Indu, and so let us become the lords of riches,
- 14 Give us your blessing, O ye Gods, preservers. Never may sleep or idle talk control us.
But evermore may we, as friends of Soma, speak to the synod with brave sons around us.
- 15 On all sides, Soma, thou art our life-giver : aim of all eyes, light-finder, come within us.
Indu, of one accord with thy protections both from behind and from before preserve us.

HYMN XLIX.

Agni.

AGNI, come hither with thy fires ; we choose thee as Invoking Priest.

Let the extended ladle full of oil balm thee, best Priest, to sit on sacred grass.

9 *Aim of men's eyes* : or, beholder of men.

12 *Immortal in himself* : see note on I. 18. 4.

13 *Soma* : here the Moon-God, who is intimately connected with the Pitris or Fathers. See *Hymns of the Atharva-veda*, XVIII. 4. 72.

I place at the end of this Book the eleven hymns, called the *Valakhilya*, which are usually inserted after Hymn XLVIII. These hymns are not

- 4 The horse would draw an easy car, gay hosts attract the laugh and jest.

The male desires his mate's approach, the frog is eager for the flood. Flow, Indu, flow for Indra's sake.

HYMN CXIII.

Soma Pavamāna.

LET Vṛitra-slaining Indra drink Soma by Saryanāvân's side,
Storing up vigour in his heart, prepared to do heroic deeds.
Flow, Indu, flow for Indra's sake.

- 2 Lord of the Quarters, flow thou on, boon Soma, from Ârjika land,
Effused with ardour and with faith, and the true hymn of sacrifice. Flow, Indu, flow for Indra's sake.

- 3 Hither hath Sûrya's Daughter brought the wild Steer whom Parjanya nursed.

Gandharvas have seized hold of him, and in the Soma laid the juice. Flow, Indu, flow for Indra's sake.

- 4 Splendid by Law! declaring Law, truth-speaking, truthful in thy works,

Enouncing faith, King Soma! thou, O Soma, whom thy maker decks. Flow, Indu, flow for Indra's sake.

- 5 Together flow the meeting streams of him the Great and truly Strong.

The juices of the juicy meet. Made pure by prayer, O Golden-hued, flow, Indu, flow for Indra's sake.

- 6 O Pavamāna, where the priest, as he recites the rhythmic prayer,

Lords it o'er Soma with the stone, with Soma bringing forth delight, flow, Indu, flow for Indra's sake.

- 7 O Pavamāna, place me in that deathless, undecaying world
Wherein the light of heaven is set, and everlasting lustre shines.

Flow, Indu, flow for Indra's sake.

- 8 Make me immortal in that realm where dwells the King, Vivasvân's Son,

Where is the secret shrine of heaven, where are those waters young and fresh. Flow, Indu, flow for Indra's sake.

1 *Saryanāvân*: a lake in the Kurukshetra district.

2 *Of the Quarters*: of the four regions of the sky. *Ârjika land*: according to Sâyana, the country of the Rîjikas. Cf. VIII. 7. 29.

3 *The wild Steer whom Parjanya nursed*: the mighty Soma-plant whose growth has been fostered by the God of the rainy cloud. *Sûrya's Daughter*: *Śraddhâ* or Faith. Cf. IX. 1. 6. *Gandharvas*: guardians of the heavenly Soma. See Vol. I., Index.

4 *Thy maker*: the Soma-presser, or the institutor of the sacrifice:—'the upholder (of the rite).'—Wilson.

5 *The King*: Yama, the ruler of departed spirits, son of Vivasvân. See Vol. I., Index.

- 9 Makemeimmortal in that realm where they move even as they list,
In the third sphere of inmost heaven where lucid worlds are
full of light. Flow, Indu, flow for Indra's sake.
- 10 Make me immortal in that realm of eager wish and strong desire,
The region of the radiant Moon, where food and full delight
are found. Flow, Indu, flow for Indra's sake.
- 11 Make me immortal in that realm where happiness and trans-
ports, where
Joys and felicities combine, and longing wishes are fulfilled.
Flow, Indu, flow for Indra's sake.

HYMN CXIV.

Soma Pavamāna.

THE man who walketh as the Laws of Indu Pavamāna bid,—
Men call him rich in children, him, O Soma, who hath met thy
thought. Flow, Indu, flow for Indra's sake.

- 2 Kasyapa, Rishi, lifting up thy voice with hymn-composers' lauds,
Pay reverence to King Soma born the Sovran Ruler of the
plants. Flow, Indu, flow for Indra's sake.
- 3 Seven regions have their several Suns; the ministering priests
are seven;
Seven are the Âditya Deities,— with these, O Soma, guard thou
us. Flow, Indu, flow for Indra's sake.
- 4 Guard us with this oblation which, King Soma, hath been
dressed for thee.

Let not malignity conquer us, let nothing evil do us harm.
Flow, Indu, flow for Indra's sake.

9 *Where they move even as they list*: 'where action is unrestrained.'—Muir.
'Where the sun wanders at will.'—Wilson.

10 *Of the radiant Moon*: the adjective *bradhndasya*, of the ruddy or brilliant,
stands without a substantive. 'Sun' is supplied by Sâyana. 'Des rota-
tralenden.'—Ludwig. See Hillebrandt, *Vedische Mythologie*, I., 396.

As regards the joys of the departed, referred to in stanzas 7—12, Professor
von Roth observes (*Journ. Amer. Orient. Soc.* iii. 343, quoted by Dr. Muir,
O. S. Texts, V. 307) 'The place where these glorified ones are to live is heaven.
In order to show that not merely an outer court of the divine dwellings is
set apart for them, the highest heaven, the midst or innermost part of heaven,
is expressly spoken of as their seat. This is their place of rest; and its
divine splendour is not disfigured by any specification of particular beauties
or enjoyments, such as those with which other religions have been wont to
adorn the mansions of the blest.... There they are happy: the language used
to describe their condition is the same with which is denoted the most exalted
felicity.'

2 *Kasyapa*: the seer of the hymn addresses himself.

3 *Seven regions*: the regions of the sky, the four quarters with intermediate
points. They are sometimes said to be five, six, or seven in number, but
more frequently eight. *Âditya Deities*: Varuṇa, Mitra, Aryaman, Bhaṇa,
Dakṣha, Aṇṣa, and perhaps Dhâtara. Other enumerations also are given, and
their number is sometimes said to be eight. See M. Müller, *Vedic Hymns*, I.
p. 252f (*Sacred Books of the East*, XXXII).